



Turkmenistan

The "land of the Turkmen" nomads is famous for its Akhal-Teke racehorses—the country's national emblem.

Hold your horses.



Uzbekistan

Uzbekistan is a major producer of cotton, and also has one of the world's largest gold mines, as well as vast reserves of natural gas and oil.

It's a top pick!



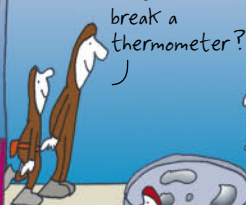
Kazakhstan

The first Kazakhs were nomads who traveled around on horses. Horse-racing remains popular today, while kumis—fermented mare's milk—is the national drink. Cheers!

Kyrgyzstan

Mountainous Kyrgyzstan has a wealth of exploitable natural resources: the perfect landscape for hydroelectric power stations, and vast reserves of mercury and gold, which it exports.

Did someone break a thermometer?



Tajikistan

Its plentiful supplies of uranium, used in nuclear power generation, are the mainstay of Tajikistan's economy.

Atomic!

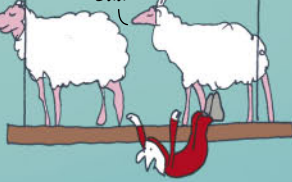
Central Southern Asia

The Muslim countries of Afghanistan and Pakistan lie sandwiched between India, Iran, and central Asia. Both countries are home to many different peoples speaking many different languages.

Karakul sheep

Afghan farmers breed the karakul sheep—one of the oldest domesticated sheep breeds—for its distinctive curly fleece.

Baa!



Pakistan

An important cotton-producer, Pakistan has developed a large textile industry around this.

Are we packed yet?



This is industrial-strength cotton.



By bus

The brightly decorated buses, often lit by holiday lights, are the most colorful way to travel around Pakistan.



Afghanistan

The different groups of peoples that live in Afghanistan traditionally have their own distinguishable hats.



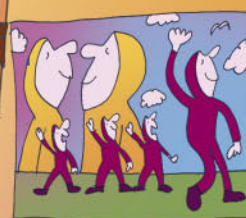
Spinning cotton

The chakra, or spinning wheel, became a symbol for Indian independence through inspirational leader Mahatma Gandhi.

This is wheelie cool.



I like my independence.



Indian subcontinent

With more than one-fifth of the world's population, the Indian subcontinent is home to many different ethnic groups and religions, epitomized by the symbolic Lotus Temple in New Delhi, in which followers of all religions are invited to worship.

It's a wrap.



Bhutan

The world's only Buddhist kingdom, Bhutan lies high up in the Himalayas. Here, yaks are tended for their meat, milk, hair, and tails.



Nepal

Native Nepalese known as Sherpas serve as guides for the many mountaineers who come to climb Everest and other Himalayan mountains.

Does this strike a cord?



Bangladesh

Low-lying Bangladesh is ideal for growing jute—a tough, fibrous plant that is used to make rope, sacking, and carpet backing.



Maldives

Coconuts are an important harvest in the Maldives, where tuna fishing and tourism are also major industries.

Incoming!



Sri Lanka

Sri Lanka is the world's second largest producer of tea, which is grown in the country's humid, hilly interior.

Tea for two.

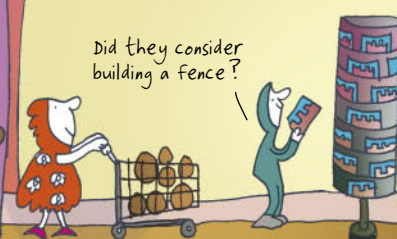
Bollywood

A fusing of "Bombay" (as Mumbai used to be known) with "Hollywood," the term "Bollywood" refers to a particular style of Indian film, popular among Indians living throughout the world.

East Asia

The ancient country of China is today the world's most populated nation, with the fastest-growing economy. To its north is Mongolia—a landlocked country that is rich in mineral resources.

Did they consider building a fence?



The Great Wall of China

First constructed around 200BC and then much enlarged and lengthened, the world's longest structure—at almost 4,000 miles (6,400km) long—snakes across China.

This is great!

